Enter to Learn, Leave to Succeed

CORPORATE MENTORING PROGRAM

INTELLECTUAL OUTCOME

Submitted by:
Vinayak Dubey
Corporate Mentee
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FIIB

Submitted to:
Mr. Sankalp Shrivastava
Lead - RM and Strategic Pricing
FedEx Corporation
Corporate Mentor, CMP

Intellectual Outcome

The Corporate Mentoring Program was not just an academic requirement for me. It was a responsibility, a leadership role, and a learning process that unfolded at multiple levels simultaneously. As the CMP Coordinator, I was not only a mentee but also someone responsible for ensuring the smooth functioning of the entire program. Managing mentors, coordinating with students, aligning schedules, handling communication gaps, and ensuring that the program delivered value required constant attention and structured planning.

CMP, in reality, felt like managing a live operational system. There were multiple stakeholders involved. Faculty, mentors, students, administration, and external professionals all had expectations. Balancing these expectations while managing my own academic commitments created a different kind of pressure. At times, academic deadlines, coordination tasks, and stretch assignment work overlapped heavily. This experience exposed my limitations in time management and prioritization, but it also forced me to improve.

Every small interaction with my mentor added a new layer to my understanding. Some discussions were detailed and structured. Others were brief but impactful. What stayed consistent was the shift in perspective. Instead of looking at problems at a surface level, I began to understand how systems operate beneath visible processes. I learned to ask better questions. Where is value being created. Where is inefficiency forming. What trade offs are being made. What is the structural reason behind a decision.

Before CMP, my understanding of air cargo was basic. I thought of it simply as goods arriving at the airport, going through customs checks, being loaded into an aircraft, and reaching their destination. I was not thinking about cost structures, air freight pricing, operational bottlenecks, stakeholder coordination, or regulatory sequencing. I did not understand how deeply interconnected the ecosystem actually is.

Through Stretch Assignment 1, I encountered my first major intellectual challenge. Finding strong, relevant case studies was much harder than I had anticipated. Identifying companies, validating information, structuring insights, and aligning everything with dynamic pricing and revenue optimization required significant effort. The three case studies I included demanded extensive reading, comparison, and restructuring. This process made me realize that research is not just about collecting information. It is about interpreting it correctly and presenting it with clarity and logic. I discovered gaps in my ability to synthesize complex information within a limited timeframe.

Stretch Assignment 2 presented a different challenge. It was originally designed to be observational, centered around a field visit to the IGI Air Cargo Terminal. Due to access constraints requiring corporate sponsorship, the observational component could not be executed. Initially, this felt like a setback. However, instead of allowing it to weaken the assignment, I shifted the approach toward structured secondary research.

Within a short period, I watched multiple industry videos, studied customs workflows, mapped cargo processes, and reconstructed the operational ecosystem of the terminal. Watching around six focused videos just to understand the terminal layout made me realize how little I had previously understood about infrastructure design, integrator terminals, APEDA facilities, strong room operations, and customs clearance flow.

At the same time, I became aware of the limitations of this research approach. Secondary research allows structural mapping, but it cannot fully replicate real world observation. Bottlenecks were identified conceptually, not physically measured. Turnaround time analysis was inferred, not validated. This limitation itself became a learning. I understood the difference between theoretical mapping and empirical validation.

Balancing CMP coordination, academics, and both stretch assignments required discipline. There were periods where time felt insufficient. Managing communication loops, responding to stakeholders, ensuring alignment,

and completing research demanded mental consistency. It was not simply about completing tasks. It was about sustaining focus under pressure.

The most significant intellectual shift for me has been the change in how I view operations. I no longer see air cargo as just movement of goods. I see it as capacity economics, regulatory sequencing, infrastructure alignment, and stakeholder synchronization. I no longer approach assignments as submission requirements. I approach them as structured problems that need analytical thinking under constraints.

CMP taught me that operations is not about visible activity. It is about invisible structure.

I learned how pricing connects to capacity perishability. I understood how customs hierarchy shapes process flow. I saw how infrastructure limitations create bottlenecks. I experienced how stakeholder alignment determines whether a system runs smoothly or breaks under pressure. I learned how research design must adapt when constraints exist. And I learned what it means to handle responsibility beyond personal academic performance.

CMP was not just a mentoring initiative. It was exposure to complexity. It was exposure to leadership under constraints. It was exposure to structured thinking.

When I entered the program, I saw individual parts.
When I leave the program, I see interconnected systems.

That shift in perspective is the most meaningful intellectual outcome of this entire journey.
